Ideal Stockist Profile & Research Process (Lumen & Pine Candle Co.)

2026-10-25

> This document shows how a virtual assistant supports Lumen & Pine Candle Co., a fictional online shop for hand-poured soy candles led by CEO Olivia Hartwell. All stores, names, emails and details are invented for this sample.

Process Name	Last Updated	Owner	Frequency	Next Review
Wholesale Lead Research	2026-10-25	Jesyka, Virtual Assistant	Weekly batch of 15 to 20 leads	2027-01-25

1. The Problem

Lumen & Pine only found new stockists when a store happened to reach out. There was no list of target stores, no way to tell a good fit from a poor one, and no contact details ready for outreach.

2. Ideal Stockist Profile

Criteria	A good fit	Not a fit
Store type	Independent home, gift, decor, plant or book shops	Large chains and discount stores
Location	US Pacific Northwest and Mountain West first, then the rest of the US	Outside shipping zones
Price point	Sells gifts in the $25 to $60 range	Mostly items under $10
Values	Features local, handmade or small-batch makers	Mass-produced stock only
Online presence	Active Instagram or website updated in the last 3 months	No posts or updates in 6 months
Decision maker	Owner or buyer can be reached directly	Only a general contact form

3. Fit Score

Each store gets a score out of 12, so the best leads are contacted first.

Points	Already sells candles	Price point fit	Local or handmade focus	Instagram activity
3	Yes	$25 to $60 gifts	Features makers often	Posts every week
2	n/a	Mixed price range	Some local products	Posts every month
1	No	Mostly low price	Rarely features makers	Rarely posts

10 to 12: contact this week. **7 to 9:** contact next batch. **6 or below:** keep on file.

4. Where I Find Leads

- **Instagram:** location tags and hashtags such as #shopsmallportland, plus stores that tag other candle brands
- **Google Maps:** searches like "gift shop" and "home decor" in each target city
- **Apollo.io and Snov.io:** owner and buyer names, roles and business emails
- **Referrals:** stores recommended by existing stockists

5. Research Steps

1. Search one city at a time and add every possible store to the lead list.
2. Check the store's website and Instagram, then score it against the profile.
3. Find the owner or buyer using the store website, LinkedIn, Apollo.io or Snov.io.
4. Verify the email with a validation tool. Mark it **Verified** only if it passes; otherwise mark it **Pending**.
5. Remove duplicates and closed stores. Mark existing stockists in the notes so they get a reorder message instead of a first pitch.
6. Move leads with a score of 10 or more to the Wholesale Follow-up Tracker for outreach.

> Use only business contact details that stores share publicly or that come from approved tools. Never guess personal emails, and remove anyone who asks not to be contacted.

6. Quality Check Before Handing Over a Batch

☐ Every lead has a store name, city, website or Instagram, and a source
☐ Every score adds up correctly
☐ Every email is marked Verified or Pending
☐ No duplicates, and existing stockists are marked in the notes
☐ Notes explain anything unusual about the store

Sample project prepared by Jesyka Egonio, JEMNexaVA. Lumen & Pine Candle Co. and every store listed are fictional.